

Technology News

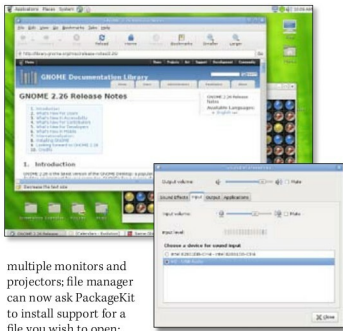
GNOME 2.26 has arrived!

GNOME 2.26 has been released this March with many new features, improvements, bug fixes, and updated translations. You can try it out with the LiveCD, by downloading it from the [torrent.gnome.org](#).

Some of the major feature additions in this release are:

- Evolution has acquired the ability to import Microsoft Outlook Personal Folders (PST files) directly in Evolution. E-mail, contacts, appointments, tasks and journal entries are supported. Additionally, support for Microsoft Exchange's MAPI protocol has also been included.
- Media Player has also got several new features. Many media playing appliances now offer the option of sharing the stored content via either the UPnP or DLNA protocols. With the new Coherence DLNA/UPnP client, it is possible to browse and play this content from within the GNOME Media Player. While GNOME's Media Player already had the ability to display subtitles for a movie, this still required you to have the subtitle data available. As of GNOME 2.26, this restriction no longer exists. Using the new subtitle downloader plug-in, the Media Player will automatically find subtitles for you.
- The Empathy instant messaging application, which uses the Telepathy communications framework, has acquired a feature that includes file transfers when supported by Telepathy (currently Jabber and link-local XMPP), chat room invite support, sound themes and notifications, and an improved VoIP experience. VoIP via the free Theora and Speex codecs is now possible over Jingle, to clients that support them.

In addition to all these, some other features include: volume control integrated with PulseAudio; support for



multiple monitors and projectors; file manager can now ask PackageKit to install support for a file you wish to open; password entry widgets will now warn you if your Caps Lock key is enabled; changing the Input Method type using the context menu on a text entry widget is now per-widget, rather than per-application; Deskmn now supports OpenSearch plugins; new visual effects, such as the panels sliding in and out at login and logout, and cross-fading desktop backgrounds; a file manager plug-in to enable simple personal file sharing over WebDAV, HTTP and Bluetooth.

Of course, the above are just a few features that are evident to the general desktop users. In addition to these, there are significant improvements in accessibility and developer tools. For details visit [www.gnome.org](#).

Tux takes a vacation in Linux 2.6.29

Some 13 months in the making, Linux Torvalds has finally released Linux kernel 2.6.29. "The most obvious change is the (temporary) change of logo to Tuz, the Tasmanian Devil," he wrote in the Linux Kernel Mailing List (LKML) announcing the release. The temporary logo change was made to raise awareness for the cause of saving the endangered Tasmanian devil. "But there're a number of driver updates and some m68k header updates (fixing

headers_install after the merge of non-MMU/MMU) that end up being pretty noticeable in the diffs."

The latest release debuts a



preliminary version of Btrfs, a filesystem that's being designed to offer better fault tolerance and easier administration (compared to ext 4).

Ext4, which was tagged stable in the previous kernel release, has been updated to run without a journal in v2.6.29, alongside the addition of version 4.0 of

the Squashfs, a filesystem popular in embedded device development.

Other significant features and updates in Linux 2.6.29 include: Kernel-based Mode Setting (KMS) for improved graphics hardware handling and enhanced displays; filesystem freeze support; Tree RCU; WiMAX 802.17 subsystem and drivers; improved Wi-Fi; and eCryptfs filename encryption. You can check out the complete changelog at [kernel.org/pub/linux/kernel/v2.6/ChangeLog-2.6.29](#), and download it from [kernel.org](#).